

EBOOK

Opening Repertoire

Guide

Build a solid opening repertoire with both White and Black pieces.

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Part I: Your White Repertoire

The Italian Game

We recommend the Italian Game (1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4) as your primary weapon with White. It's one of the oldest and most logical openings in chess.

The Italian Game after 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4



Key Ideas for White

- Control the center with e4 and d4
- Develop quickly: Nf3, Bc4, O-O, d3 or d4
- Attack the f7 square — the weakest point in Black's position
- After castling, aim for a central pawn break with d4

Against the Giuoco Piano (3...Bc5)

After 3...Bc5, play 4.c3 preparing d4. This is the Giuoco Piano, leading to rich middlegame positions. White gets a strong center and active piece play.

Against the Two Knights (3...Nf6)

After 3...Nf6, the main line is 4.d3 (the safe Italian). This keeps a solid structure and avoids sharp complications. Play Bc4, O-O, Re1, and build pressure.

Part II: Black vs 1.e4 — The Sicilian Defense

Against 1.e4, we recommend 1...c5 (the Sicilian Defense). It's the most popular response at all levels and gives Black active counterplay.

Sicilian Defense: 1.e4 c5



Key Sicilian Ideas

- ⚡ Fight for the d4 square — if White plays d4, exchange cxd4
- ⚡ Use the semi-open c-file for counterplay
- ⚡ Develop with ...Nf6, ...d6, ...a6, ...e5 or ...e6
- ⚡ Black often castles kingside and attacks on the queenside

Part III: Black vs 1.d4 — King's Indian Defense

Against 1.d4, we recommend the King's Indian Defense (1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6). It's dynamic, aggressive, and leads to exciting games.

Key King's Indian Ideas

☞ Manoeuvre the Bishop to g7 — it becomes a powerful piece

☞ Castle kingside quickly

☞ Strike in the center with ...e5 or ...c5

☞ If the center closes, attack on the kingside with ...f5

Part IV: Practical Tips

- Focus on understanding IDEAS, not memorizing moves
- Study 2-3 games in each opening to see the plans in action
- Practice your repertoire in online blitz/rapid games
- Review your games to find opening mistakes
- Expand your repertoire gradually as you improve

TIP: A small repertoire you understand deeply is better than a wide one you barely know. Master one opening for White and one for Black before expanding.